Gee Bee SUPER SPORTSTER

The Gee Bee R1 and R2 Super Sportster were designed specifically for the 1932 Thompson and Bendix races. They were the fastest planes of their time, and certainly the most recognizable ones with their so particular shape. Constructed by the Granville brothers and engineer Howell W. "Pete" Miller, they earned a reputation of dangerous machines...

For those interested in learning more about the history of these particular aircrafts and their builders, I recommend the following books and sites:

- ***'THE GEE BEE RACERS' A Legacy of Speed*** by Charles A. Mendenhall & Tom Murphy - Specialty Press
  The story of the Granville Brothers and their machines.
- ***GEE BEE*** by Delmar Benjamin and Steve Wolf - Motorbooks International
  The story of the creation of the R2 replica.
- http://www.webcitation.org/query?url=http://www.geocities.com/CapeCanaveral/lab/4515/index3.html&

THIS PACKAGE CONTAINS THE FOLLOWING MODELS:

- Gee Bee R1 Super Sportster
  1932 version (first flight configuration)

- Gee Bee R1 Super Sportster
  1932 version

- Gee Bee R2 Super Sportster
  1932 version

- Gee Bee R1 Super Sportster
  1933 version

- Gee Bee R2 Super Sportster
  1933 version

GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

- speed is in **mph**.
- Be sure to set the **flight model per frame at 2** or more (**Operations and Warning** menu)
- Plane must be **trimmed before take-off** due to massive engine torque.
- Don't apply full throttle on take-off, especially with R1 model.
- **Side door opens** with speedbrakes command.
- You can **remove the windshield** by pressing an invisible button above the artificial horizon.
- The interior, handles and panel are not 100% accurate (will occur in a future update... maybe).
- **Pilot** modified from the one found in the **SBACH 300 from Bertrand 'Beber' Augras** at XPFR --> www.xpfr.org Check it!

Gee Bee R1 Super Sportster

1932 *version* (first flight configuration)

INTRODUCTION

In its original version, the rudder of the R1 had no vertical fin. This induced the ship to fishtail badly. This has been fixed just after the first flight, with two square feet of fin added.



NR2100 number 11

CHARACTERISTICS

Empty weight : 1840 lb
Gross weight : 3075 lb with full tanks - 2415 lb fo racing
Powerplant : 800 horsepower Pratt & Whitney Wasp Sr. 1344
Maximum speed : 300 mph
Tail wheel : moving with rudder (can be unlatched for easier handling)
Propeller : Smith controllable pitch
Nav light : null

Gee Bee R1 Super Sportster

1932 *version*

INTRODUCTION

In september the 7th, the R1, flown by pilot James H. Doolittle, won the Thompson Trophy pylon race, at an average speed of 252,7 mph.



NR2100 number 11

CHARACTERISTICS

Empty weight : 1840 lb
Gross weight : 3075 lb with full tanks - 2415 lb for racing
Powerplant : 800 horsepower Pratt & Whitney Wasp Sr. 1344
Maximum speed : 300 mph
Tail wheel : moving with rudder (can be unlatched for easier handling)
Propeller : Smith controllable pitch
Nav light : null

Gee Bee R2 Super Sportster
1932 *version*

INTRODUCTION

The R2 is the sister ship of the R1. Except a few minor differences, they were identical. The R2 was intended to compete the Bendix Trophy, a cross country race from Los Angeles to Cleveland. Lee Gehlbach flew it and made fourth. Gehlbach also entered the Thompson Trophy and took the fifth place.



NR2101 number 7

CHARACTERISTICS

Empty weight : 1796lb
Gross weight : 3883 lb with full tanks - 2371 lb with 50 gallons of fuel for close course racing
Powerplant : 550 horsepower Pratt & Whitney Jr. 985
Maximum speed : 250 mph
Tail wheel : fixed (can be unlatched for easier handling)
Propeller : Smith controllable pitch
Nav light : wing tip and tail fin

Gee Bee R1 Super Sportster
1933 *version*

INTRODUCTION

In 1933 the R1 is re-engined with a more powerful engine. To counteract the increased torque, a 10 inch rudder extension is added at the lower end. Participating to the Bendix Trophy this year, the plane crashed on take-off in Indianapolis. Pilot Russell Boardman died two days later.



NR2100 number 11

CHARACTERISTICS

Powerplant : around 1000 horsepower Pratt & Whitney R-1860
Tail wheel : fixed
Propeller : Smith controllable pitch
Nav light : null

Gee Bee R2 Super Sportster
1933 *version*



INTRODUCTION

In 1933 the R2 is re-engined with the R1's previous engine. Rudder extension is added in the same way that for the R1. New wings are thicker and have an increased area. Flaps are added too, lowering the landing speed at 65 mph.

NOT INCLUDED IN THIS PACKAGE

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